

10_SYMPTOM_SCORE_INTERPRETATION



SYMPTOM SCORE INTERPRETATION GUIDE

Understanding Depression and Anxiety Score Predictions



DEPRESSION SCORE SCALE (0-30)

Score Ranges and Meanings:

● 0-9: Minimal Depression

Clinical Meaning: Very few or no depressive symptoms

Daily Experience:

- Generally positive mood most days
- Good energy and motivation
- Normal sleep patterns
- Enjoyment of activities and relationships
- Effective coping with normal life stressors

Why This Score Occurs:

- 1 Contributing Factors:
- 2 ✓ Excellent sleep quality (7-9 hours nightly)
- 3 ✓ Low stress levels (1-3/10)
- 4 ✓ Strong social support network
- 5 ✓ Regular physical activity
- 6 ✓ Good work-life balance
- 7 ✓ Absence of significant life stressors
- 8 ✓ Effective coping strategies
- 9 ✓ Generally optimistic outlook

● 10-17: Mild Depression

Clinical Meaning: Noticeable but manageable depressive symptoms

Daily Experience:

- Occasional low moods or sadness
- Some fatigue or decreased energy

- Minor sleep disturbances
- Slightly reduced interest in activities
- Some difficulty concentrating
- Mild appetite changes
- Generally functional but with effort

Why This Score Occurs:

- 1 Contributing Factors:
- 2 ✓ Moderate stress levels (4-6/10)
- 3 ✓ Suboptimal sleep (5-7 hours)
- 4 ✓ Some life stressors present
- 5 ✓ Adequate but not strong social support
- 6 ✓ Occasional coping strategy challenges
- 7 ✓ Mild work or relationship stress
- 8 ✓ Beginning of symptom awareness
- 9 ✓ Some rumination or worry patterns

18-22: Moderate Depression

Clinical Meaning: Significant depressive symptoms affecting daily life

Daily Experience:

- Frequent sad or irritable moods
- Noticeable energy decrease
- Regular sleep problems
- Loss of interest in many activities
- Difficulty concentrating on tasks
- Appetite or weight changes
- Social withdrawal tendencies
- Some interference with work/school

Why This Score Occurs:

- 1 Contributing Factors:
- 2 ✓ High stress levels (7-8/10)
- 3 ✓ Poor sleep quality (4-6 hours)
- 4 ✓ Significant life stressors or changes
- 5 ✓ Limited social support
- 6 ✓ Ineffective coping strategies
- 7 ✓ Work or academic pressure
- 8 ✓ Relationship difficulties
- 9 ✓ Negative thought patterns increasing

23-30: Severe Depression

Clinical Meaning: Debilitating depressive symptoms severely impacting functioning

Daily Experience:

- Persistent sadness or emptiness
- Severe energy depletion
- Major sleep disruption
- Inability to enjoy most activities
- Significant concentration problems
- Major appetite/weight changes
- Social isolation
- Marked interference with all life areas
- Possible thoughts of self-harm

Why This Score Occurs:

- 1 Contributing Factors:
- 2 ✓ Extreme stress levels (9-10/10)
- 3 ✓ Severe sleep deprivation (<4 hours)
- 4 ✓ Multiple concurrent stressors
- 5 ✓ Minimal social support
- 6 ✓ Maladaptive coping (substance use, avoidance)
- 7 ✓ Major life crises or losses
- 8 ✓ Chronic stress without relief
- 9 ✓ Hopelessness and helplessness feelings
- 10 ✓ Biological vulnerability factors

ANXIETY SCORE SCALE (0-21)

Score Ranges and Meanings:

0-7: Minimal Anxiety

Clinical Meaning: Very little anxiety or worry

Daily Experience:

- Generally calm and relaxed
- Manageable stress responses
- Good emotional regulation
- Comfortable in most situations
- Confident decision-making

- Rare physical anxiety symptoms
- Effective problem-solving

Why This Score Occurs:

- 1 Contributing Factors:
- 2 ✓ Low baseline stress (1-3/10)
- 3 ✓ Excellent stress management skills
- 4 ✓ Strong sense of control over life
- 5 ✓ Good physical health
- 6 ✓ Supportive environment
- 7 ✓ High self-confidence
- 8 ✓ Effective relaxation practices
- 9 ✓ Minimal life uncertainties

● 8-13: Mild Anxiety

Clinical Meaning: Noticeable but manageable anxiety symptoms

Daily Experience:

- Occasional nervousness or worry
- Some situational anxiety
- Mild physical tension
- Occasional racing thoughts
- Minor sleep disruptions
- Some avoidance of anxiety-provoking situations
- Generally manageable with effort

Why This Score Occurs:

- 1 Contributing Factors:
- 2 ✓ Moderate stress levels (4-6/10)
- 3 ✓ Some life uncertainties or changes
- 4 ✓ Mild perfectionism tendencies
- 5 ✓ Occasional overwhelm with responsibilities
- 6 ✓ Some social anxiety in specific situations
- 7 ✓ Beginning awareness of anxiety patterns
- 8 ✓ Generally adequate coping skills

● 14-17: Moderate Anxiety

Clinical Meaning: Significant anxiety symptoms affecting daily comfort

Daily Experience:

- Frequent worry or nervousness

- Regular physical anxiety symptoms
- Difficulty relaxing or unwinding
- Avoidance of many situations
- Racing thoughts and rumination
- Noticeable sleep interference
- Some panic-like episodes
- Interference with social or work activities

Why This Score Occurs:

- 1 Contributing Factors:
- 2 ✓ High stress levels (7-8/10)
- 3 ✓ Multiple ongoing worries or concerns
- 4 ✓ Perfectionism or high standards
- 5 ✓ Significant life pressures or deadlines
- 6 ✓ Social anxiety in many situations
- 7 ✓ Physical health concerns contributing
- 8 ✓ Limited relaxation or downtime
- 9 ✓ Catastrophic thinking patterns

● 18-21: Severe Anxiety

Clinical Meaning: Debilitating anxiety symptoms severely impacting functioning

Daily Experience:

- Constant worry and fear
- Frequent panic attacks or intense anxiety episodes
- Severe physical symptoms (rapid heartbeat, sweating, trembling)
- Extensive avoidance behavior
- Intrusive anxious thoughts
- Major sleep disruption
- Significant social and occupational impairment
- Feeling constantly "on edge" or hypervigilant

Why This Score Occurs:

- 1 Contributing Factors:
- 2 ✓ Extreme stress levels (9-10/10)
- 3 ✓ Multiple severe life stressors
- 4 ✓ Trauma history or PTSD symptoms
- 5 ✓ Phobic avoidance patterns
- 6 ✓ Medical conditions exacerbating anxiety
- 7 ✓ Substance use affecting anxiety
- 8 ✓ Severe perfectionism or control issues

- 9 ✓ Chronic uncertainty or instability
- 10 ✓ Biological predisposition to anxiety

FACTORS INFLUENCING SCORE PREDICTIONS

Primary Predictors (Weight: 70-80%):

Stress Level Impact:

- 1 Stress 1-3: Depression -2 to +2 points, Anxiety -1 to +1 points
- 2 Stress 4-6: Depression +3 to +6 points, Anxiety +2 to +4 points
- 3 Stress 7-8: Depression +7 to +12 points, Anxiety +5 to +8 points
- 4 Stress 9-10: Depression +13 to +18 points, Anxiety +9 to +14 points

Sleep Quality Impact:

- 1 Sleep 7-9 hours: Depression -3 to 0 points, Anxiety -2 to 0 points
- 2 Sleep 5-7 hours: Depression +2 to +5 points, Anxiety +1 to +3 points
- 3 Sleep 3-5 hours: Depression +6 to +12 points, Anxiety +4 to +8 points
- 4 Sleep <3 hours: Depression +13 to +18 points, Anxiety +9 to +14 points

Social Support Impact:

- 1 Support 75-100: Depression -4 to -1 points, Anxiety -3 to -1 points
- 2 Support 50-75: Depression -1 to +2 points, Anxiety 0 to +1 points
- 3 Support 25-50: Depression +2 to +5 points, Anxiety +1 to +3 points
- 4 Support 0-25: Depression +6 to +10 points, Anxiety +4 to +7 points

Secondary Predictors (Weight: 20-30%):

Age Effects:

- 1 18-25 years: Slight increase in both scores (adjustment period)
- 2 26-50 years: Baseline scoring
- 3 51-65 years: Slight decrease in scores (life experience)

Gender Differences:

- 1 Female: +1 to +3 points on anxiety scores
- 2 Male: +0 to +2 points on depression scores
- 3 Non-binary: +2 to +4 points on both (unique stressors)

Lifestyle Factors:

- 1 Physical Activity 5-7 days: Depression -2 to -4 points
- 2 Physical Activity 2-4 days: Depression 0 to +2 points
- 3 Physical Activity 0-1 days: Depression +3 to +6 points
- 4
- 5 Work Environment (Remote): Anxiety -1 to -2 points
- 6 Work Environment (On-site): Anxiety +1 to +2 points
- 7 Work Environment (Hybrid): Anxiety 0 points



SCORE TRENING AND IMPROVEMENT

What Score Changes Indicate:

Improving Pattern (Scores Decreasing):

- 1 Month 1: Depression 22, Anxiety 16
- 2 Month 2: Depression 18, Anxiety 13 (-4, -3 points)
- 3 Month 3: Depression 14, Anxiety 10 (-4, -3 points)
- 4
- 5 INDICATES: Effective treatment/intervention
- 6 Contributing factors likely improving:
- 7 ✓ Better sleep habits established
- 8 ✓ Stress management skills developing
- 9 ✓ Social support increasing
- 10 ✓ Coping strategies becoming effective
- 11 ✓ Lifestyle changes having positive impact

Worsening Pattern (Scores Increasing):

- 1 Month 1: Depression 12, Anxiety 8
- 2 Month 2: Depression 16, Anxiety 12 (+4, +4 points)
- 3 Month 3: Depression 21, Anxiety 17 (+5, +5 points)
- 4
- 5 INDICATES: Deteriorating situation
- 6 Contributing factors likely worsening:
- 7 ✓ Increased life stressors
- 8 ✓ Sleep quality declining
- 9 ✓ Social support decreasing
- 10 ✓ Coping strategies failing
- 11 ✓ New challenges emerging

Stable Pattern (Minimal Changes):

- 1 Month 1: Depression 15, Anxiety 11
- 2 Month 2: Depression 14, Anxiety 12 (-1, +1 points)
- 3 Month 3: Depression 16, Anxiety 10 (+2, -2 points)
- 4
- 5 INDICATES: Mixed or plateaued progress
- 6 May need:
- 7 ✓ Treatment approach adjustment
- 8 ✓ Additional intervention strategies
- 9 ✓ Addressing specific persistent factors
- 10 ✓ Enhanced support systems

PERSONALIZED SCORE EXPLANATIONS

Example 1: Why a Student Has High Scores

- 1 Profile: 22-year-old female student
- 2 Predicted Scores: Depression 24, Anxiety 19
- 3
- 4 DETAILED EXPLANATION:
- 5 "Your high predicted scores reflect the perfect storm of student stress factors:
- 6 • Academic pressure: Final exams and thesis deadlines (stress 9/10)
- 7 • Sleep deprivation: Pulling all-nighters regularly (sleep 4-5 hours)
- 8 • Social isolation: Studying instead of socializing (support 35/100)
- 9 • Financial worries: Student loans and job market concerns
- 10 • Future uncertainty: Post-graduation anxiety
- 11 • Perfectionism: High standards leading to self-criticism
- 12
- 13 The model recognizes this constellation of factors as highly predictive of severe symptoms. Your age group typically shows elevated scores due to major life transitions and identity development challenges."

Example 2: Why a Professional Has Moderate Scores

- 1 Profile: 38-year-old male manager
- 2 Predicted Scores: Depression 17, Anxiety 14
- 3
- 4 DETAILED EXPLANATION:
- 5 "Your moderate scores stem from the balancing act of mid-career demands:
- 6 • Work-life balance challenges: Long hours affecting home life (stress 7/10)
- 7 • Career advancement pressure: Meeting performance expectations
- 8 • Family responsibilities: Juggling work with parenting/partner duties
- 9 • Financial obligations: Mortgage, children's education costs

- 10 • Some sleep disruption: Occasional work-related insomnia (sleep 6 hours)
- 11 • Decent support network: Colleagues and family provide some buffer
- 12
- 13 The model sees this as typical 'middle adulthood stress' where responsibilities peak but coping skills are still developing. Your gender may also influence help-seeking patterns and symptom expression."

Example 3: Why a Retiree Has Low Scores

- 1 Profile: 62-year-old retired person
- 2 Predicted Scores: Depression 6, Anxiety 4
- 3
- 4 DETAILED EXPLANATION:
- 5 "Your low scores reflect the protective factors common in healthy aging:
- 6 • Reduced work stress: Retirement eliminates occupational pressure
- 7 • Better sleep: More consistent sleep schedule (sleep 7-8 hours)
- 8 • Strong relationships: Time to nurture family and friendships (support 85/100)
- 9 • Established routines: Predictable daily structure
- 10 • Wisdom and perspective: Life experience providing emotional regulation
- 11 • Good physical health: Active lifestyle and self-care
- 12 • Financial stability: Reduced economic anxiety
- 13 • Sense of accomplishment: Life review tends to be positive
- 14
- 15 The model recognizes that while aging brings challenges, many seniors develop excellent coping skills and prioritize what truly matters for wellbeing."



SCORE IMPROVEMENT STRATEGIES

Targeted Interventions by Score Range:

For High Scores (23-30 Depression OR 18-21 Anxiety):

1. **Immediate:** Professional assessment and treatment planning
2. **Sleep Focus:** Sleep hygiene protocols, possibly medication
3. **Stress Reduction:** Intensive stress management training
4. **Support Building:** Family involvement, support group connection
5. **Activity Scheduling:** Structured daily routines
6. **Crisis Planning:** Safety protocols and emergency contacts

For Moderate Scores (18-22 Depression OR 14-17 Anxiety):

1. **Short-term:** Counseling or therapy initiation
2. **Lifestyle Changes:** Regular exercise, improved nutrition
3. **Skill Building:** Relaxation techniques, cognitive strategies
4. **Social Connection:** Planned social activities
5. **Problem-Solving:** Addressing specific stressors
6. **Monitoring:** Weekly check-ins on progress

For Mild Scores (10-17 Depression OR 8-13 Anxiety):

1. **Prevention Focus:** Stress management education
2. **Self-Care Enhancement:** Better sleep, exercise, hobbies
3. **Support Network:** Strengthening existing relationships
4. **Mindfulness Practices:** Meditation, breathing exercises
5. **Goal Setting:** Small, achievable wellness goals
6. **Education:** Understanding normal vs. concerning symptoms

For Minimal Scores (0-9 Depression AND 0-7 Anxiety):

1. **Maintenance:** Continuing healthy habits
2. **Prevention:** Regular mental health check-ups
3. **Resilience Building:** Advanced coping skill development
4. **Community Involvement:** Volunteering, mentoring others
5. **Optimization:** Performance enhancement strategies
6. **Support Provision:** Helping others with their mental health

This guide provides comprehensive understanding of symptom score predictions and practical strategies for improvement